

S2 contract decisions – options with impact

****From:**** S2 spike (§16 open questions) – ****Owner** calls needed before the implementer slice.
****Report:**** `design/flutter-app-builder/research/SPIKE\_S2\_REPORT.md` (committed `28b3163`).
 Decision criteria per SPIKE_PROTOCOL: each choice is catalog truth (IR/schema/contract) that ships in code, goldens, and tests – a change later is a regeneration + review, so pick for the long run.

Decision A – contract amendment: is `emphasis.targetId` dropped?

****Context:**** S1 D3 deferred `emphasis.targetId` to S2 ("lands sections[] AND emphasis.targetId together"). The S2 spike's evidence (§13 D5, §15) says: under a section-list the focal element IS the `hero` section – prominence = its position + order + `heroScale`. `targetId` would resolve to exactly the section that already declares itself, adding an IR field + cross-reference validation with zero expressive gain.

Option A1 – DROP emphasis (spike recommendation)

- IR has ****no**** `emphasis` field anywhere. Hierarchy expressed purely by: `hero` section position + `heroScale` (0/1/2) + section order.
- ****Contract:**** v2 §2.3 `emphasis` deleted; amendment note in the decision log.
- ****Impact – for:**** one less IR field to validate; no cross-reference target checks; the section-list is self-explanatory; fewer failure modes (§9). ****Against:**** if a future NON-section context (e.g. "make THIS product card pop inside a detail screen") needs focal emphasis, it has no home – a later spike reintroduces it; the S1 D3 deferral is closed without delivering its original promise.

Option A2 – KEEP emphasis for a future non-section context

- S2 ships sections WITHOUT `emphasis`. `targetId` stays in the contract (§2.3), unimplemented, documented as "future: detail/other screens".
- ****Impact – for:**** contract keeps the door open; a detail-screen "make this element pop" ask later has a pre-agreed slot. ****Against:**** a dead IR concept today – `targetId` on a section-less screen is ambiguous (targets what?); the validation burden is deferred not avoided; mild contract cruft.

Impact table

Axis	A1 DROP	A2 KEEP
IR surface	smallest (no field)	+1 field, unimplemented
Validation	none new	future target-ref gate needed
S1 D3 closure	original promise closed-without-delivery	kept open
Future non-section emphasis	needs new spike	pre-agreed slot
Today's code/tests	simplest	unchanged by absence

Decision B – archetype label for the new `screen.type` value

****Context.**** The new screen renders a section-list home. The VLM worked example calls it ``"dashboard"`` and claims it's an "existing archetype" (it is NOT – ``COMPOSITIONS`` has only `list/detail/wizard`, schema enum is closed to those three; S2 must ADD the archetype in `composition.ts` + `screen.schema.json` + `screen.ts`). The label becomes catalog truth in IR, schema, plan.json (``patterns.sections``), generated ``Screen<X>`` naming, routes, goldens, and tests.

Option B1 – ``"sections"`` (spike recommendation)

- Neutral, catalog-honest: "this screen is a section-list". ``market`/`home`/`dashboard`` become future ****personality/convention**** values (via ``visualStyle.personality``), never special-cases.
- ****Impact – for:**** vocabulary stays descriptive of the mechanism; S2-gate note (``VLM_DESIGN_T0_IR_CONTRACT_V2.md:323-326``: catalog truth only after spike proves it) satisfied; no semantic overload ("dashboard" implies analytics). ****Against:**** less product-flavored; the VLM example text must be amended (``"dashboard"`` → ``"sections"``).

Option B2 – ``"home"``

- Product-oriented: implies the app entry/home screen.
- ****Impact – for:**** reads naturally in IR/screens. ****Against:**** a home screen is a PRODUCT role, not a layout mechanism – a home could also be a list/detail today; adds ambiguity ("home" as type vs "home" as first screen). Minor mismatch if a sections screen is ever not the entry.

Option B3 – ``"dashboard"``

- The literal label in the VLM worked example A.
- ****Impact – for:**** matches the contract's existing text; familiar. ****Against:**** connotes analytics/admin dashboards; the example's own framing ("NOT market") shows the label is contested; carrying a misnamed type into schema/code is harder to unwind later than picking right now.

Impact table

Axis	B1 sections	B2 home	B3 dashboard
Contract-text delta	amend example (dashboard→sections)	amend example	none (matches)
Semantic accuracy	mechanism-true	product-role	analytics-connoted
Reuse risk	market/dashboard = future personalities	could collide with 'first screen' logic	locks in a contested name
Schema/code stability	high	medium	low

Suggested combined decision (for the owner to ratify or edit)

> ****A1 DROP emphasis**** (hierarchy = hero + order + heroScale) ******* B1 ``"sections"`` (neutral > archetype; contract example amended). Both are the spike's evidence-based recommendations; they minimize IR surface and keep vocabulary mechanism-true. Then the implementer slice (§14.1–14.7) ships with those labels.

Reply with the chosen options (or edits), and I'll amend the contract + write the implementation brief.